10/21 WEDNESDAY — STORY OUTLINE

Airdate: Wednesday, October 21, 2026 (F2, taped) · **Stories:** A + B + C, approved by the producer 10/13 (jeff_approval.md) · **Guest:** Lon Seidman, tech reviewer, Lon.TV (A story) · **Sponsor:** OmniWatch (2 breaks) · **Stage:** videos

RUNNING ORDER

Slot	What	Weight	Clips
Tease	The TV that watches what you watch, the rental bill with a fake photo, the energy company you never signed up for	—	—
A	Your TV is watching what you watch: turn this off tonight	~55% of show	3/3
Break	OmniWatch — after A beat 7 (Lon's bottom line)	—	—
B	They're billing you for damage you didn't do	~25%	3/3
Break	OmniWatch — after B beat 4 (your phone is your alibi)	—	—
C	Winter bills are going up, and you may have been switched to a supplier you never chose	~20%	1/1
End	End of show	—	—

Open package: A beat 3, She Prepares on Walmart and LG TVs.

The show in three sentences

Your smart TV checks what's on its screen and sells the pattern to advertisers, it's on by default, and only people in Texas were ever asked. A separate investigation says LG sets can record audio in standby, which LG denies, so we keep that claim separate and lean on what's proven: the tracking, and how to turn it off where your TV lets you. Then rental car customers get damage bills after they return the car, from Hertz's AI scanner to an owner who faked a tire photo, and as winter bills rise, a Pennsylvania woman finds she's been signed up with an electric supplier she never heard of.

The ride

A climbs from your screen to the ad companies to the claim about your living room, then exhales on a fix walked through by Lon. B climbs from a machine billing for dents you can't see to a faked photo, with a satisfying catch: she proved it was fake. C starts with a bill everyone dreads and ends on one line to check tonight, so the show exhales twice.

Decisions before we write

- Slate is final as approved (producer, 10/13). Third TV-tracking video (January ~654K, spring ~316K; Ryan says the devices video was a hit); the title has to sell a new angle (the Texas deals or the LG claim).
- No demos this show (producer, 10/13). Lon walks through where the setting usually lives (A6), and what to do when a TV doesn't have one; B and C fixes are Jeff on camera.
- A: menu paths vary by model and some TVs have no off switch (producer, 10/13). Don't promise "the one setting" works on every TV; the fix leads with "check," then the brand names, then the no-setting fallback.
- A cut from 4 clips to 3 at Checkpoint 2 (producer, 10/13): no TV owner on camera, so the old A3 is gone and A is renumbered.
- A5 · LEGAL: the Gamers Nexus cut carries the claim and not LG's denial. Jeff reads LG's statement right after it ("The claims made in the recently published video are not true").
- A is thin on people: A3 to A5 are a creator, a state and a researcher. Lon is the human in A.

- Lon Seidman: confirm booked, and check for sponsor or affiliate ties to TV brands or Roku before he gives settings advice. On his own channel he argued Texas's LG settlement "let them off the hook."
- B reworked (producer, 10/14): rental cars in general, not Turo; Hertz's AI scanner (CBS) leads as the legacy company, then Hope's fake tire photo; the payoff is a video walkaround before you return the car (reverse image search dropped); the Birmingham Turo case is cut. No 55+ victim, and both renters got their money back, so it plays as a warning with a fix.
- B: hotel fees left out (one Jeff line at most, in Jeff should know).
- C rewritten at Checkpoint 3 (producer, 10/13): the York County supplier-switch ("slamming") case is the story. The Rushmore "price protection" call stays as a Jeff line. The old C2 (a bill that tripled) is cut: the only finds were a 2022 summer bill and a 2023 package with no customer on camera.
- C savings guide: three sourced lines (check your supply rate, budget billing, LIHEAP) (producer, 10/13).
- Picks: 7/7 verified against YouTube captions (rung 1). Source mix: affiliate 3 · creator_long 3 · network 1.

A. YOUR TV IS WATCHING WHAT YOU WATCH: TURN THIS OFF TONIGHT

In one sentence: Smart TVs check what's on screen and sell that data to advertisers, it's on by default, only Texans got asked, and on most sets you can switch it off.

Hold back: the setting's name on each brand and where it hides in the menu.

Peg: Texas forced Samsung (Feb 2026) and LG (May 2026) to ask before tracking → but only in Texas → everyone else is still opted in and was never asked. "Texas got asked. You didn't." Plus the Gamers Nexus investigation (Sept 6) that put TV spying back in the news.

Framing: your smart TV, whatever the brand, on by default.

Climb: closer and closer to you: what's on your screen → who buys it → what the TV might hear in the room (disputed) → you take it back.

Weight: ~55% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The hook	You (the viewer)	Every show you watch, even a DVD or a cable box, your smart TV checks what's on the screen.	JEFF
2	It's watching	Lon Seidman, tech reviewer, Lon.TV	The feature is called ACR: snapshots of the screen matched to a database, on by default; one 2024 study clocked LG about every 15 seconds.	GUEST
3	Who's buying	She Prepares, older-audience creator (Oct 2026)	Vizio's own policy: what you watch is licensed to partners and tied to your age, location and purchases; Walmart bought Vizio for the ads.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — She Prepares 6WT5fc-LHSc
4	Only Texas got asked	Texas Attorney General's office (Dec 2025 – May 2026)	Texas sued TV makers; Samsung and LG agreed to ask Texans first, and nobody else.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — Texas TV news on the AG suits or settlements
5	The claim LG denies	Steve Burke, Gamers Nexus (Sept 2026)	His team captured microphone audio from an LG TV that looked off and was unplugged from the network; LG says the claims are not true.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — Gamers Nexus 6IFVTcM28KA
6	Turn it off, if you can	Lon Seidman	Where the setting usually lives on Samsung, LG, Vizio, Roku and Sony, over a graphic, and what to do when your TV has none.	GUEST
7	Lon's bottom line	Lon Seidman	The TV keeps working with it off, ads just get less targeted, plus the microphone setting worth checking.	GUEST

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In–Out	Status
3	She Prepares — What Walmart TVs and LG Are Really Doing When Inside Your Home…	She reads Vizio's privacy policy in plain words (viewing data licensed to partners, combined with age, location and purchases), then why Walmart bought Vizio: the ad business. Uploaded Oct 3, 2026, 12:46, 1.23M views.	8:13–9:13 "what you buy" BUTT 10:02–10:33 "gives them to you"	PICK
4	KVUE — Texas reaches settlement with LG in smart TV privacy lawsuit	Paxton's LG settlement requires a pop-up and an opt-out; LG admits no wrongdoing; Samsung also settled;	0:00–0:49 "under this agreement" BUTT 1:08–1:16 "are still ongoing"	PICK

		Sony, Hisense and TCL cases ongoing. Uploaded May 11, 2026, 1:18.		
5	Gamers Nexus — 216,000,000 Spy TVs: The LG Smart TV Problem	Steve Burke: microphone audio captured while the TV appeared off and unplugged, stored and pulled out "by someone with remote access" through vulnerabilities. LG's denial is not in this window. Uploaded Sept 6, 2026, 2:15:52, 8.2M views.	0:26–0:52 "user reconnected the network"	PICK · LEGAL

The fix

- After She Prepares (beat 3): if your TV asked you to "agree" to anything at setup, assume the tracking is on.
- After Texas (beat 4): you're not in Texas, so nobody is going to ask you. Check it yourself.
- After Gamers Nexus (beat 5): don't wait for the listening claim to be settled; turn off what's proven.
- Look in privacy or viewing settings first; the names below are where it usually lives, and they vary by model. ⚠️ verify on 2026 sets
- Samsung: Viewing Information Services, off (Consumer Reports, how to turn off smart TV snooping, updated 10/19/2025).
- LG: Viewing Information (Live Plus), off (Consumer Reports).
- Vizio: Viewing Data, off (Consumer Reports). Vizio says turning it off won't affect how the TV works (Vizio privacy policy, per She Prepares, 9:14).
- Roku TVs: Use Info from TV Inputs, off (Consumer Reports).
- Sony: Samba Interactive TV, off (Consumer Reports).
- No setting on your TV? ⚠️ Lon to confirm the fallback (e.g. take the TV off Wi-Fi and use a streaming device); unsourced.
- Microphone: Roku, Microphone Access to Never Allow; Samsung's physical mic switch. ⚠️ unsourced, Lon to confirm.
- Do-nothing test: do nothing and the tracking stays on. Opting out did stop data going to the tracking servers in one study's tests (cited by She Prepares, 6:27). ⚠️ Check whether a software update or factory reset turns it back on.
- The one setting the tease promises is ACR, under each brand's name above (Consumer Reports).

Gaps

- ⚠️ Beat 4: the Texas suits are Dec 2025 and Samsung's deal Feb 2026, more than six months before airdate. Date them on air ("last December," "in February").
- ⚠️ Beat 2: the IMC study is 2024. Date it on air.
- ⚠️ Beats 3 and 5 are creator videos and need clearance.

Jeff should know

- Beat 5: LG says the claims "are not true," and nothing independent has confirmed them. Never say "LG is listening"; say "the investigation found" or "alleges." In Gamers Nexus's demo, the recording was retrieved "by someone with remote access" through vulnerabilities; it does not show LG collecting audio.
- Beat 5: LG told She Prepares' source that in standby the TV only listens for a wake word if far-field voice is turned on, and that audio is deleted and never sent (She Prepares, 4:31).
- Beat 4: the Texas deals cover Texans only. The KVUE window includes a line about transfers to the Chinese Communist Party (0:36–0:42).

- Beat 3: Vizio says some "activity data" is still collected even with viewing data off, unless you turn it off at setup or reset the TV (She Prepares, 9:29).
- Beat 2: the every-15-seconds figure is one 2024 study of LG sets, not every brand.
- Beat 6: Fire TV left out of the brand list (it's an Amazon device); add it only if the room asks.

B. THEY'RE BILLING YOU FOR DAMAGE YOU DIDN'T DO

In one sentence: Rental car customers are getting damage bills after they return the car, from an AI scanner at Hertz to an owner who faked a tire photo, and a video walkaround is your proof.

Hold back: the tire in the "proof" photo wasn't her car; it was a years-old picture from Reddit.

Peg: KSL's report (Oct 5) is doing 600K in a week, and holiday travel is weeks out (AAA: 81.8M Thanksgiving travelers in 2025). "Your phone is your alibi."

Framing: a damage bill that shows up after you've returned the rental car.

Climb: a machine bills you for dents you can't even see → someone fakes the damage outright → you prove it with your own video.

Weight: ~25% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The scanner	Adam Foley, San Antonio, Texas (Aug 2025)	Hertz's AI scanner bills him $350 for two small dents he never noticed; Hertz waives it after CBS asks.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — CBS Evening News 0ANywiehCCA
2	The bill	Hope Orr, Draper, Utah (Oct 2026)	After she returns a rental car, the owner bills $165 for smoking and a $500 tire charge is coming.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — KSL Get Gephardt 1_wUVS5szfw
3	The photo was fake	Hope Orr (Oct 2026)	Her own photos show a different tire tread, and the "proof" turns out to be a years-old Reddit picture; the charges are dropped.	HAVE · HORIZONTAL — KSL, same clip (second segment)
4	Your phone is your alibi	You (the viewer)	Before you hand back the keys, film a slow walkaround of the car, tires and interior.	JEFF

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In–Out	Status
1	CBS Evening News — Behind the controversial AI tech used to inspect rental vehicles for damages	AI photo booths scan returned cars; Adam Foley billed $80 for two small dents plus a $190 processing fee, $350 total; Hertz's statement (97% showed no billable damage); Hertz waives his fees after CBS asks. Uploaded Aug 27, 2025, 2:54, 275K views.	0:19–1:03 "that I didn't even detect" BUTT 1:35–1:50 "showed no billable damage" BUTT 2:23–2:28 "waved the $350"	PICK
2	KSL Get Gephardt — Car rental service attempts to scam Utah woman out of hundreds	Hope Orr: a claim for a nail in the tire and smoking ("I don't smoke"), the owner's evidence photos, a $500 charge posted. Uploaded Oct 6, 2026, 4:35, 609K views.	0:49–1:38 "actually going to cost me"	PICK
3	KSL Get Gephardt — same clip	The owner's "I've done more than 5,000 tire claims," the mismatched tread, the claim upheld, then the photo found in a Reddit post "from 4 years ago" and the claims removed.	1:40–2:51 "removed the bogus claims"	PICK

The fix

- After Adam: a damage bill by text after you've left, for something you never saw. Ask for the before-and-after photos and an itemized estimate before you pay. ⚠️ source
- After Hope: a damage photo that doesn't match your own. Your video is the proof; send it.
- The payoff: a slow video walkaround of the car, tires and interior before you return it, and at pickup too. Spend the five to ten minutes (KSL Get Gephardt, 4:01).
- Still charged? Dispute it with your card company. ⚠️ source (CFPB)

Gaps

- ⚠️ B1 Adam Foley is Aug 2025: date it on air ("last summer"). ⚠️ Check where Hertz's AI scanners stand now (it was at 10 US airports and "still refining"; Sen. Blumenthal was writing to Hertz's CEO).
- ⚠️ Hope was refunded and neither renter is confirmed 55+. No real-loss case.
- The KSL article doesn't give the photo's age, but the KSL video says "a Reddit post from 4 years ago" (B3, 2:42).

Jeff should know

- Rental cars in general, not Turo (producer, 10/14): our audience doesn't use the Turo app. Hope rented through Turo, a peer-to-peer app, from a private owner, so say "she rented a car" and "the owner," not "a rental company." The KSL clip still names Turo on screen.
- Beat 1: "more than 97% showed no billable damage" is Hertz's own figure. Hertz declined CBS's interview and said the system offers "precision and objectivity."
- Beat 3: "more than 5,000 tire claims" is the owner's own boast, in a message to Hope (KSL). Don't name him. Turo's policy: hosts who submit false claims face up to a $2,000 fee and removal (KSL, 3:10).
- Beat 2: the KSL reporter calls the owner "a liar" at 0:45; the cut starts after it. She rented the car in Miami (KSL, 0:41).
- Reverse image search is out as viewer advice (producer, 10/14): it stays only as how Hope caught him.
- The Birmingham Turo renter (Georgina Montalvan, $2,338, July 2026) is cut: a Turo case, print only.
- Hotel fees: the FTC rule since May 2025 says mandatory resort fees must be in the total price, if the room keeps a line on it.

C. WINTER BILLS ARE GOING UP, AND YOU MAY HAVE BEEN SWITCHED TO A SUPPLIER YOU NEVER CHOSE

In one sentence: As winter bills rise, people are being signed up with electric suppliers they never chose, by a forged signature at the door or a "price protection" call, and one line on the bill shows it.

Hold back: she never signed anything; someone forged her name.

Peg: EIA's winter outlook (Oct 6) says electric-heat homes pay about 4% more and heating-oil homes about 21% more → people are already worried about the bill → an offer to "lock in" a rate, at the door or on the phone, sounds like help. "The bill is real. The program isn't."

Framing: someone switches your electric supplier without your OK, at your door or on the phone.

Climb: your bill goes up → a stranger offers to help with it → you find out you've been switched without saying yes.

Weight: ~20% of show · 1 clip beat

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The bill goes up	You (the viewer)	Electric-heat homes pay about 4% more this winter, heating-oil homes about 21% (EIA, Oct 6); Illinois callers pitched "price protection."	JEFF
2	She never signed	York County, Pennsylvania woman (Sept 2024)	A letter says she's enrolled with an energy supplier she's never heard of; a door-to-door agent forged her signature.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — FOX43 kXnLrmP-Wm8
3	Check this line tonight	You (the viewer)	Find "supply" or "price to compare" on your bill, and call your utility if you don't recognize the company.	JEFF

Videos

#	Clip	Shows	In–Out	Status
2	FOX43 — Energy slamming: How you could be signed up for an energy service without approval	The letter she almost threw out, "I've never even heard of them," the forged signature, "slamming" is illegal, and the company says its third-party marketer was fired. Uploaded Sept 10, 2024, 4:41.	0:48–1:29 "never even heard of them" BUTT 1:56–2:04 "and it's illegal" BUTT 3:13–3:29 "has been terminated"	PICK

The fix

- After the woman in York County: a letter from an energy company you don't know isn't junk. Open it.
- Your utility won't call or knock to "lock" your rate. Close the door or hang up, and call the number on your bill. ⚠️ source (your utility's scam page)
- Find the supplier and "price to compare" lines on your bill. ⚠️ source (state utility commission page; the term varies by state)
- Switched without your OK? File a complaint with your state utility commission (Pennsylvania PUC, per WPXI and FOX43). ⚠️ confirm on the PUC page
- Never give your account number to a caller or a door-to-door agent (Illinois Attorney General, Rushmore Energy settlement, 6/4/2026). ⚠️ confirm the AG's page says it
- Budget billing to spread winter costs (your utility). ⚠️ source
- LIHEAP for help paying heating bills, through your state. ⚠️ verify 2026–27 funding (acf.hhs.gov)

- Do-nothing test: if you were already switched, doing nothing keeps you on their rate. Call your utility to switch back, and ask about cancellation fees. ⚠️ source

Gaps

- ⚠️ C2 York County woman is Sept 2024: date it on air ("a couple of years ago").
- ⚠️ Her name is garbled in the auto-captions; get it from FOX43's article before the bible.
- ⚠️ Supplier switching only exists in states with retail choice. The tell has to work for viewers everywhere.

Jeff should know

- Beat 2: the supplier in the FOX43 story is Indra Energy (licensed under Palmco); Indra said it couldn't tell how its door-to-door marketer got her information and fired the marketer. Pennsylvania's PUC was investigating. Don't name the company on air unless the room wants to.
- Beat 1: the Rushmore matter is a settlement of the Illinois AG's allegations; "nearly double" is the AG's wording. ⚠️ Check whether Rushmore admitted anything.
- Beat 1: don't say data centers doubled bills. Leave data centers out.
- Beat 3: in states without supplier choice there's no supply company to switch, and a call like this is a scam outright.